

Avery Hughes

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity | Indiana Institute of Technology

May 2027

WORK EXPERIENCE

Security Analyst | Indiana Cyber Network | Fort Wayne, IN

January 2026 – Current

- Assess security controls for 6 clients across defense, manufacturing, government, education, and nonprofit sectors.
- Investigate security events and map attack paths, escalating high-risk findings and tracking them to resolution.
- Tailor testing to client compliance needs, including NIST SP 800-53 and FedRAMP for a defense contractor.
- Serve as a day-to-day technical contact during engagements, coordinating fixes directly with client IT teams.
- Present findings and remediation roadmaps to client leadership, translating technical risk into business impact.

Cybersecurity Intern | DuCharme, McMillen & Associates, Inc. | Fort Wayne, IN

April 2026 – Current

- Automate CrowdStrike Falcon agent deployment across 1000+ endpoints, firewall policy, and SOAR workflows via Ansible.
- Automate export of GitLab SAST, dependency, and container findings into Jira as tracked remediation tickets across 50 repos.
- Deploy k3s clusters for GitLab Workspaces developer environments, managing DNS, TLS, and Ansible provisioning.
- Develop Windows and Linux hardening baselines with automated compliance scanning and gap analysis.
- Architect an isolated malware analysis lab on Proxmox with CAPEv2, FLARE VM, and REMnux for sample detonation.

Program Developer & Digital Literacy Educator | Ball Venture Grant | Fort Wayne, IN

October 2025 – April 2026

- Developed and delivered hybrid training sessions for seniors on technology basics and cybersecurity awareness.
- Increased participants in digital confidence and engagement by teaching safe online practices and social connectivity tools.

IT Service Agent | Indiana Institute of Technology | Fort Wayne, IN

September 2025 – January 2026

- Resolved 100+ IT tickets monthly, troubleshooting network, software, MFA, SSO, Microsoft Office, and hardware issues.
- Assisted in deploying and maintaining campus-wide IT infrastructure for 1,500+ students and faculty.

Data Center Technician | Indiana Institute of Technology | Fort Wayne, IN

August 2025 – July 2026

- Integrated NetBox IPAM, Splunk monitoring, and LDAP to centralize visibility and strengthen infrastructure management.
- Standardized configurations and documentation to enhance maintainability and reduce operational overhead.

Undergrad Research Assistant | University of Notre Dame | Remote

February 2025 – May 2026

- Designed and implemented encryption, key-management, and access-control modules to enhance security and data integrity.
- First-author publication in *Springer CCIS* — “[Secure and Scalable Data Management Using Web3DB](#).”

Team Captain, Unix Lead & Offensive Security Lead | Indiana Institute of Technology

July 2024 – July 2026

- Captained a 20+ member competitive team, leading Unix and team-wide training and directing competition strategy.
- Developed exercises and reports on penetration testing, system hardening, and incident response for team training.

PROJECTS

ClassCloud | ClassCloud.net

- Built a Python/Flask platform that bulk-provisions and manages VMs across AWS and Proxmox for 100+ students.
- Secured browser-based access with Microsoft SSO and Cloudflare Tunnel, removing exposed ports and VPN needs.

Self-Hosted Infrastructure Lab

- Isolated IoT devices on a separate OPNsense VLAN with DNS filtering to limit lateral movement and malicious domains.
- Enabled remote access through NetBird zero-trust networking, fronting all services with HAProxy and wildcard TLS.

For a full list of projects, please visit my [website](#)

Skills, Leadership, Competitions, Honors & Awards

- **Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon, Splunk, Wazuh, Arctic Wolf, OPNsense, CAPEv2, FLARE VM, REMnux
- **Systems & Automation:** Python, Bash, Linux, Windows Server, Proxmox, Ansible, Terraform, Docker, GitLab CI/CD
- **Leadership:** Team Captain and Unix Lead (Cyber Warriors), Offensive Security Lead
- **Honors:** Springer CCIS First Author, Ball Venture Grant Recipient, Indiana Tech Innovation Challenge Winner
- **National Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition** | 2x Indiana Qualifier | 2x Midwest Qualifier | 1x National Appearance
 - Defended an enterprise network against a live red team, handling incident responses and injects.
- **Collegiate Penetration Testing Competition** | 2x Appearance
 - Performed client-style penetration tests and authored findings reports to a simulated client board.
- **Department of Energy CyberForce Competition** | 1x Appearance